

Before you hand this to a teenager

Written for roughly ages 12 to 18.

There are two files. The student packet holds the lesson, the five pulls, the specimens, the week-long hunt and the worksheet. These teacher's pages hold this page, the instructions for The Letter, and the three handouts that go with it. Print the student packet for them. Keep this one.

Do it on your own feed first

Open whatever you look at most, run one Spot the Pull sheet on the first thing that catches you, and see what comes back. You'll teach it better. More to the point, you won't be teaching it from above it. Nobody is outside this, and that's the lesson.

A vague answer is a real answer

"I don't know, I just wanted it" is a fine place to start. Precision comes from doing this more than once, not from doing it well the first time. Resist correcting a student toward a better-sounding answer.

When they say it's obvious

They're partly right. Anyone can spot it in a commercial. Ask them to run a sheet on something they already bought, or something they already believe. That's where it stops being obvious.

If every verdict comes back negative, it isn't working

A student who concludes that everyone is running a play on them has learned suspicion, which is easier and far less useful. At least one entry should end in "that was fair and I went along with it on purpose." Say that out loud, early.

Someone will say "so we're the fish?"

The student packet compares a video hook to bait chosen for a particular fish. That comparison puts your student in the position of the fish, and one of them will notice and say it out loud, probably as a joke. Agree with them. It's funny, and it's also true, and the alternative is a room absorbing the idea that they're prey without ever saying so. If nobody says it, say it yourself.

Don't let them see the last three pages

They hold the questionnaire, the reading and the checklist for The Letter. A student who reads ahead can't be shown anything, so hand them out one at a time and send students only the student packet.

Time

One sitting for the lesson. One week for the hunt.

Run this one: The Letter

Have them fill out a short questionnaire, something personal-sounding that tells you nothing useful. A song, a skill, a place. Tell them a reading is coming back.

Give everyone the same letter.

Let them read privately first. Then ask whether anyone wants to read theirs out loud. Someone will, because it's uncanny how well it fits.

The room figures it out. That part isn't your job.

Then, in this order

1. Apologize for lying. Out loud, before you explain anything.
2. Go through the letter together. What fit, what didn't.
3. Ask what wording would have worked better. This is the question that turns them from the person being read into the person who wrote it.
4. Run the checklist on the letter.
5. Run it again on the questionnaire. The invitation was already working before anyone read a word of their letter, and catching that is the harder, better win.

The question to ask at the end

Not "see, you were fooled," but "what did it feel like in the half-second you decided it was accurate?"

One warning

Skip the apology, or run it with a gotcha in your voice, and you'll get defensiveness instead of laughter, which closes the rest of the lesson. The five steps above aren't optional and the order matters.

If lying to students bothers you

It should bother you a little. Here is why it works anyway. The lie is the lesson: you can't show someone what it feels like to be read accurately by describing it, only by doing it. The apology is part of the method and comes before any explanation. And the dissection afterward hands them the pen, which is why a room that has just been fooled laughs instead of feeling humiliated. If it still sits wrong with you, skip it. The specimens teach the same lesson without it.

If it's one teenager rather than a room

Hand over the reading, have them underline every line that feels accurate, then show them the same letter underlined by somebody else. Or have them write one for a person they've never met and watch how easy it is to make it fit.

Personal Insights Survey

A friend of mine reads charts and does personal readings. She's written books, teaches classes, and travels to do seminars. Because she's my friend, she's offered to do free readings for my students. Normally these cost \$99.

I won't tell you her name until after you get your readings. I will say that she tends to be very accurate.

To help her understand your personality and destiny, she asked that you fill out the following.

NAME	DATE OF BIRTH
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1. What's a song you'd put on if nobody else could hear it?

2. If you woke up tomorrow able to do one thing perfectly, what would it be?

3. Name a place you've never been that you think about anyway.

Your Personalized Reading

There's a part of you that keeps score on yourself. You'll replay something you said hours after you said it and wonder whether it came out the way you meant it. Most people never go back and check. You do.

People who meet you once tend to think they have you figured out. People who know you well know better. You can be easy in a crowd and still leave it needing an hour by yourself, and both of those are really you. Sometimes you're the one keeping the conversation going, and part of you is standing slightly outside it, watching.

You hold some things back. Not out of secrecy, but because you've learned that not everyone has earned the whole picture. You've been wrong about that before, in both directions, and it taught you something you haven't entirely put into words.

You've started more things than you've finished. An instrument, maybe. A notebook you meant to keep. Something you were good at quickly and then set down. You tell yourself you lost interest, though it's closer to the truth to say you were waiting for the thing that would hold you.

You think in questions. You'd rather work something out yourself than be handed the answer. That independence serves you well, and it's worth remembering that even the sharpest thinkers get further with help than without it.

There's more in you than you've spent. You aim high, which is exactly why you stall: starting badly feels worse to you than not starting. Once you're actually inside something, though, you move faster than you expected to, and you surprise yourself. You'll know better than I do what that costs you.

What stands out most is how open you still are. That's rarer than you think. People feel it before they can name it.

Thank you for letting me read for you,

Maren Ashgrove, QPA, MSRC

Does it describe you, or could it fit most of the room?

For each statement, mark yes or no.

- ☐ 1. Vague enough that most people could say "yep, that's me"?
- ☐ 2. Mostly flattering? Think creative, intuitive, deep.
- ☐ 3. Covers both extremes? "You're outgoing, but sometimes need time alone."
- ☐ 4. Describes common experiences? Doubting decisions, wanting approval, worrying about money.
- ☐ 5. Hard to test? Is there no clear way to show it's wrong?
- ☐ 6. Leaves blanks for you to fill with your own memories and details?
- ☐ 7. Leans on an impressive source or mystical explanation instead of evidence?

- ☐ 8. Encourages you to notice what fits and overlook what doesn't?

Seven of these are about the writing. The eighth is about you. That one works on everything in this lesson, not just this letter.

These are clues, not a diagnostic score. A "yes" doesn't prove a statement is false. Ask whether it tells you anything specific about you.

**Something can be true of you
without being unique to you.**
